AI EDGE DIAGNOSTIC™ · FULL REPORT · 2026

Boundary Builder

Edge Holding — Structurally intact. Active compounding required.

AI EDGE INDEX™

62–67

Range · adjusted from base 60 · ±5 margin

VS PEERS	TRAJECTORY	LEVEL TARGET	GAP TO CLOSE
+2 above	Expanding ↑	76	9–14 pts

Director of Strategy · Consulting & Advisory

Enterprise · India · 11–15 years experience · 6–10 years managing people

WHAT IS WORKING

Above cohort on every dimension. Framing and Deciding both expanding — the two most protected dimensions. Trajectory is positive and in the right direction.

WHAT IS AT RISK

35% of your week is in work AI performs at 88–95% quality. Decision Depth is 22 points below the Director target — the primary career-limiting gap.

IF YOU DO NOTHING

AI is advancing into Analysis and Insight — 35% of your current work. Inertia at this level produces a 10-point drift over 18 months. The window to compound is open now.

SCORE	ARCHETYPE	WHAT IT MEANS
80–100	Structural Architect	AI amplifies your leverage. You direct; others produce.
70–79	Strategic Leverager	Judgment-dominant. Your 6-month target.
60–69 ◀	Boundary Builder	**You are here.** Edge established. Deliberate compounding needed.
50–59	Output Manager	Judgment and output balanced. Active management required.
<50	Execution Operator	Output-primary. Immediate composition shift required.

SECTION 02

Is your compensation safe?

Salary Defensibility

Moderate-to-strong · Sensitive to the next 12 months

Moderate

CURRENT POSITION	THE RISK	WHAT CHANGES IT FASTEST
Compensation is stable. Your expanding trajectory and strategic altitude justify Director-level pay today.	35% of your time is in work AI performs at near-human quality. As firms reprice that layer, the compensation case needs a stronger judgment argument.	Reduce AI-Dominant below 25%. Own consequential decisions with a documented track record. Make your thinking visible before the work begins.

Director compensation in Consulting compounds above a score of 76 — where judgment is clearly primary. The 9–14 point gap to that threshold is the difference between pay that tracks inflation and pay that grows with your position.

SECTION 03

What does your work look like today?

AI-PROOF

45%

Framing problems, owning decisions, judgment under ambiguity. AI cannot do this.

Target: 50%+ · Gap: 5pp

AI-ASSISTED

20%

You direct; AI produces. Own the question before and the interpretation after.

Target: 26% · Upgrade quality

AI-DOMINANT

35%

AI performs this at 88–95% quality today. Research, first drafts, reporting.

Target: below 25% · Gap: 11pp

STRATEGIC	TACTICAL	OPERATIONAL
55%	30%	15%
Defining direction and problems	Translating plans within direction	Executing within plans

THE READ

Your altitude (55% Strategic) matches your protection (45% AI-Proof). You are doing the right work at the right level. The AI-Dominant 35% is 11pp above the Director target, and the AI-Proof 45% sits 5pp below the 50% floor. Both are closable in 6 months.

What needs to change

AI-Dominant must drop: 35% → below 25%	35%
AI-Proof must rise: 45% → 50%+	45%
AI-Assisted: hold 20–26%, upgrade quality	20%

Vertical marker = target

THE KEY RULE

Routing AI-Dominant work frees 16–18% of your week. That recovered time must go explicitly to Framing and Deciding — not to more coordination or analysis. The routing does not improve your position. The redirection does.

SECTION 04

What stands out — strengths and risks

STRENGTHS

Trajectory expanding in the right dimensions

Framing and Deciding both grew over 12 months — the two most AI-proof dimensions. You are moving toward problem ownership and consequence bearing.

Growth Signal: 74 · Framing ↑ · Deciding ↑

Above cohort on every dimension

Judgment Ownership +9. Thinking Ownership +7. Index +2. You are building from ahead of most Directors at your level.

RISKS

Decision Depth: 22 points below target

You lead judgment and contribute to decisions — but the call and consequence sit above you. In Consulting this is the Director-to-Partner gap. It is a language and position change, not a capability change.

Current: 52 · Target: 74 · Gap: 22 pts

AI-Dominant 11pp above Director target

Not a crisis, but above the threshold where the compensation case holds independently. Routing three specific activities closes most of this within 90 days.

35% current · <25% target · 16–18% of week recoverable

You vs. peers at Director level

Your AI Edge Index	64	
Cohort average — Strategy / Consulting	62	
Director target	76	
AI-Proof %	45%	vs 39%
AI-Dominant %	35%	vs 41%

Vertical marker = cohort average · You are above cohort on both dimensions

SECTION 05

All 6 work dimensions

The table below is the complete read. Click any row for sub-activities and detail.

%	DIMENSION	WHAT TO DO
20%	Dom Research	Route 75% to AI immediately. Protect the question formulation only.

Web research, document scanning, synthesis	Route now	95% parity
Competitor and market scanning	Route now	92% parity
Data gathering and extraction	Route now	90% parity
Relevance filtering — which signals matter	Manage	65% parity
Defining the research hypothesis — scope and assumptions	Protect	15% parity
Defining what to research — the question before the search	Protect	12% parity

75% of Research time is in fully-automated activities. The only protected act: deciding *what* to investigate and why — where 11–15 years of pattern recognition creates value AI cannot replicate.

Why route: The question formulation is yours. The scanning is not. Route the scanning; protect and expand the question.

⚠ **Constraint:** Partner expects personally-authored research as a quality signal.

Decision: Have the conversation proactively — "same quality standard, AI-assisted production, freeing capacity for judgment work." That conversation held first converts a constraint into a seniority signal.

→ **This week:** Write question and hypothesis (15 min). Feed to AI (20 min). Reframe and validate (20 min). Target: Research drops to 10–12% by Month 3.

20% Asst Analysis

Route computation. Own the question before and the interpretation after.

Statistical analysis, quantitative models, metrics	Route	88% parity
Structured option evaluation — scoring alternatives	Route	85% parity
Pattern identification across complex data	Manage	70% parity
Causal inference — what is actually driving this outcome	Manage	45% parity
What to analyse and why — and interpreting results for this decision	Protect	18% parity

Half of Analysis is already at near-full compression. The value is not running the model — it is deciding what to model, and interpreting what results mean for the decision. Those two acts — before and after — are AI-proof.

Why upgrade quality not time: Define the analytical question before anything is produced. Write the interpretation before presenting. Your cognitive contribution doubles without any time change.

→ Before any analysis: write the question and the decision it must inform. After: write the interpretation paragraph before presenting. Route the computation.

15% Proof Insight Generation

Shift from synthesis toward reframing insight. Document before the deck.

Synthesis — combining findings into a narrative	Watch	72% parity
Known-framework application to new situations	Watch	65% parity
Cross-domain connection — patterns from outside the problem	Protect	22% parity
Aligning patterns into solution-oriented conclusions	Protect	18% parity
The reframing insight — conclusion that changes the question	Protect	10% parity
Naming the pattern — articulating what others haven't seen	Protect	8% parity

Synthesis is at 72% parity and advancing — if most of your Insight work is synthesis, your 15% is more compressible than the label implies. The genuinely protected acts are the reframing insight and naming patterns. With 11–15 years of cross-client exposure, your cross-domain connection is the asset.

→ Before every insight: ask — am I synthesising what the data shows, or naming something the client hasn't seen? Route synthesis to AI. Spend your 15% on the reframe and the naming. Write the insight statement before the deck.

15%	Proof ↑ Framing	Protect absolutely. Never below 12%. Challenge the brief, don't just refine it.	
Refining given briefs — sharpening scope within an existing frame		Watch	45% parity
Co-designing problem structure with stakeholders		Protect	20% parity
Defining the problem independently — before anyone asks		Protect	8% parity
Challenging the brief — reframing what question is worth answering		Protect	5% parity

This is expanding — the most positive signal in your profile. The Director who challenges the client's brief performs the highest-value act per hour available in Consulting. Brief refinement (45% parity) is compressible. Brief challenge (5% parity) is not.

Why protect absolutely: AI can refine a brief. It cannot decide the brief is the wrong question. That judgment requires accumulated context across clients — which you carry at Director level.

⚠ **Constraint:** Challenging the brief requires a Partner relationship that supports it.

Decision: Before the next engagement, have one conversation: "I want to write a brief-challenge note at kick-off — shared with you before the client." That framing creates the space without friction.

→ Before every engagement brief: write one paragraph — does this brief correctly identify the problem? If not, name the reframe. That document, dated and shared, is your highest-value act per hour.

15%	Proof ↑ Deciding & Directing	Shift sub-mix from recommendations to owned calls. Start the Decision Log.	
Recommending options for others to decide		Watch	60% parity
Operational decisions within defined parameters		Watch	50% parity
Trade-off decisions under genuine ambiguity		Protect	20% parity
Setting direction that shapes what others do		Protect	10% parity
Owning consequential decisions — your name on the outcome		Protect	5% parity

This dimension is expanding — the second strongest signal. But if your 15% is primarily recommending options (60% parity) rather than owning consequential calls (5% parity), the AI-proof label is misleading. This is the Decision Depth gap.

Why consequence ownership is the only durable act: AI generates excellent recommendations. It cannot own what follows when the call is wrong. The Director-to-Partner distinction rests entirely on which side of that line you are on.

→ Target at least 50% of your Deciding time in trade-off decisions and above — not option generation. Start the Decision Log (Section 06). Never let this allocation drop below 12%.

15%	Dom Executing	Route first drafts and meeting notes this week. Retain quality review.	
Data processing, cleaning, formatting		Route now	95% parity
First drafts — decks, documents, client emails		Route now	93% parity

Meeting notes and action tracking	Route now	90% parity
Status updates and structured reporting	Route M2	88% parity
Cross-stakeholder coordination	Manage	55% parity
Quality review and editorial judgment on all outputs	Retain	15% parity

At 15%, the allocation is already below the danger zone. The routing step: first drafts and meeting notes account for most of this time and are at 90–93% parity. Routing them frees 5–7% of your week — enough to close the 5pp AI-Proof gap to 50% on its own.

→ Route first drafts and meeting notes this week. Write the narrative arc first (5 bullets: problem, argument, conclusion, implication, recommendation). AI produces the draft. You apply editorial judgment. Target: Executing at 8–10% by Month 3, recovered time goes to Framing.

SECTION 06

The Decision Log

> WHAT IT IS — IN ONE SENTENCE
>
> A running record of every consequential decision you made, what you expected to happen, what actually happened, and what you learned — written at the time of the decision, not reconstructed afterwards.

In Consulting, judgment is invisible. When decisions happen verbally, the reasoning disappears. When outcomes are reviewed retrospectively, the original thinking has been shaped by what actually happened. The Decision Log captures your reasoning before the outcome — the only evidence that demonstrates genuine judgment ownership rather than outcome attribution.

Over 6 months, 12–18 entries create a track record that directly supports Partner consideration and compensation conversations. No performance review can manufacture it. No AI tool can produce it.

The five fields

FIELD	WHAT TO WRITE
The decision	"I decided to..." — not "we decided." The language is a record of ownership.
The rationale	2–3 sentences: why you made this call and what alternatives you rejected.
Expected outcome	What you expect before seeing the result. This is the most important field — your judgment on record, uncontaminated by what happened.
Actual outcome	Written 30–90 days later. Do not edit the original. The comparison is the value.
What I learned	One sentence on what this tells you about your judgment or what to do differently.

A worked example

ENGAGEMENT REFRAMING DECISION	
The decision	I decided to reframe the engagement from a sales productivity review to an incentive structure redesign.
The rationale	Three weeks of data showed the driver was incentive misalignment, not headcount or process. A productivity review would have found symptoms, not causes.

Expected outcome	Client CHRO will resist — the reframe challenges her existing hypothesis. If the incentive analysis confirms the pattern, the engagement delivers a more defensible recommendation and a larger follow-on scope. Partner must be aligned before the client conversation.
Actual outcome	Resistance confirmed. Partner alignment required. Incentive analysis confirmed the pattern. Scope extended 6 weeks. CHRO credited the reframe in the debrief.
What I learned	Brief-challenge decision was correct. The resistance pattern is predictable. Brief the Partner before the client — that sequence reduces friction every time.

Second example — Team talent decision ▶

The decision	I decided to replace the Senior Analyst in the engagement lead role with the Associate who has shown stronger analytical judgment.
The rationale	Three consecutive quality misses, not deadline misses. The Senior Analyst is technically proficient but not at the judgment level required for client-facing lead responsibility at this engagement complexity.
Expected outcome	Short-term disruption. Senior Analyst demotivated for 2–3 weeks. Client quality improves immediately. The Associate grows faster in the lead role than in a supporting one.
Actual outcome	Disruption as expected. Development conversation more productive than anticipated. Client quality improved Week 1. Associate exceeded expectations.
What I learned	This decision was delayed 3 weeks by discomfort. Earlier action would have preserved more client quality time. Discomfort is not a reason to delay a clear call.

HOW TO USE IT

One entry per consequential decision. Write the first four fields immediately. Return 30–60 days later for outcome and learning. Share monthly with your Partner as a briefing on *decisions taken* — not options pending. That distinction is the signal.

SECTION 07

What to do next — three priorities, in order

Sequenced deliberately. Do not attempt all three in Week 1. Each builds on the previous.

PRIORITY 1 Route AI-Dominant work — this month

WHY FIRST

Until the compressible work is routed, there is no recovered time to redirect to Framing and Deciding. Priorities 2 and 3 require the cognitive bandwidth that routing creates. Route first, redirect second, build third.

W1 **Route research — your next research task, this week**

Write question and hypothesis (15 min). Feed to AI (20 min). Reframe and validate (20 min). Total: 55 min vs. 2–3 hours. Never scan from scratch again.

> Why W1: Research is highest-parity and easiest to route without cultural friction. Start here to build the habit.

W2 **Route first drafts — your next deck or document**

Write the narrative arc first: 5 bullets (problem, argument, conclusion, implication, recommendation). AI produces the draft. You refine the argument and apply editorial judgment.

> Why W2: Two routing workflow changes in W1 reduce compliance with both. Establish research first, then extend to drafts.

M1 Route meeting notes. Run the Hollow Edge check.

Set up AI transcription. Then audit: is AI producing output and you framing? Or is AI framing and you reviewing? If the latter — the Hollow Edge: you appear AI-proof but you are doing AI-Dominant work without the label. Reclaim the framing immediately.

M2 Verify the recovered time is actually going to Framing or Deciding

If the 16–18% recovery has been absorbed by more coordination or analysis — redirect explicitly. The routing does not improve your position. The redirection does.

⚠ Constraint: Partner expects personally-authored research or drafts as a quality signal.

Decision: Have the conversation before the change — "same quality standard, AI-assisted production, freeing capacity for judgment work." Proactive framing converts a constraint into a seniority signal.

PRIORITY 2 — Own one decision per month — start the Decision Log

WHY SECOND

Decision Depth is the largest gap (22 points) and the most career-critical. It benefits from the cognitive bandwidth routing creates. The Decision Log is the most powerful career document you will build — it cannot be produced retrospectively, cannot be attributed to AI, and directly evidences consequence ownership over time.

M1 Start the Decision Log — first entry for a current decision

Open a simple document. Write your first entry using the five fields in Section 06. Date it. See the worked example for exactly what each entry looks like.

M1 Find one decision and take it — not recommend it

One decision you would normally present as options — make the call. Name the consequence path. Brief your Partner on your decision. Language: "I've decided to..." not "I'd recommend we consider..."

M2 Brief leadership monthly on decisions taken

A short note: decisions made, consequences expected, what you are tracking. Not a request for approval. A record of calls taken. That distinction compounds in how you are evaluated.

Q1 Expand to one new decision category per quarter

Come to the conversation with the decision already made and the consequence path named — not a set of options for the Partner to choose from.

⚠ Constraint: Culture discourages Directors from making calls without Partner sign-off.

Decision: Engagement scoping, team composition, analytical approach, timeline within fixed scope — these are already yours. Start there. Build the track record. Do not wait for permission to own what is already yours.

PRIORITY 3 — Make your thinking visible — problem statement before every significant piece of work

WHY THIRD — AND WHY IT STARTS IN WEEK 1 ANYWAY

This is Priority 3 because it benefits from the space created by P1 and P2. But the habit itself — 15 minutes before each significant piece of work — starts Week 1. A problem statement written before analysis cannot be attributed to AI, cannot be reconstructed retroactively, and is the clearest evidence of original thinking you can produce.

W1 Write one problem statement — for your next piece of work, this week

Before opening any data: write the actual problem (not what the brief says), your initial hypothesis, and what would change your mind. One paragraph. Date it. That document predates the analysis and cannot be attributed to AI.

W2+ **Make it standard — no significant work starts without a written problem statement**

15 minutes. Every engagement, every significant deliverable. By Month 6: 24+ problem statements — a record of original thinking no performance review can reconstruct.

M1 **Write your first thinking artifact — one page, shared with one person**

One page: a pattern you are observing, what you think it means, what you would recommend, what would change your view. Share with one senior stakeholder. Month 1 of a monthly habit. By Month 6: six artifacts on record.

SECTION 08

Review schedule and success criteria

Three checkpoints. Success means the position has shifted — not that habits have been adopted. The test is always the number.

Month 1 — foundations started? Day 30

AREA	SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE	PASS MARK
Routing	Research and first drafts routed consistently. Recovered time redirected to Framing or Deciding — not absorbed by more output work.	Routing active
Decision Log	Log started. At least 2 entries. At least 1 decision briefed to Partner as a decision taken.	2 entries
Thinking	Problem statement written before at least 3 significant pieces of work.	3 statements
Hollow Edge	First audit done: AI is producing, you are framing. If reversed — framing reclaimed immediately.	Audit done

Month 3 — position moving? Retake Quick Mirror. Day 90 · Quick Mirror

SIGNAL	CRITERIA	PASS MARK
AI-Dominant	Moved from 35% to 28% or below. If not: recovered time is being absorbed by more output work — audit and redirect.	≤ 28%
AI-Proof	Moved from 45% to 48% or above. If not: Framing and Deciding time must increase explicitly.	≥ 48%
Decision Log	6 or more entries. At least 2 with outcome data. Partner briefed on decisions taken at least twice.	6 entries
Quick Mirror	Decision Depth moving toward 57+. Thinking Ownership toward 62+. Overall index: 64–68.	Index 64–68
Floors held	Framing ≥ 12%. Deciding ≥ 12%. Strategic layer ≥ 50%. AI-Dominant ≤ 30%.	All held

Month 6 — position compounded? Retake Full Diagnostic. Day 180 · Full Diagnostic

SIGNAL	CRITERIA	PASS MARK
AI Edge Index	Moved from 62–67 to 68–73. Shift from mid-Boundary Builder toward Strategic Leverager.	68–73
AI-Dominant	At 25% or below. All three categories consistently routed. Quality review retained.	≤ 25%
AI-Proof	At 50% or above. Majority of working hours above the compression line.	≥ 50%
Decision Depth	Score at 62 or above. 12+ log entries with outcome tracking. Partner briefed monthly for 4+ months.	Score ≥ 62
Thinking	Thinking Ownership at 65+. 6 thinking artifacts on record.	Score ≥ 65
Trajectory	Still Expanding. Framing and Deciding both at 15%+. Expansion sustained and compounded.	Expanding ↑

Floors — check monthly, act immediately if breached

SIGNAL	NOW	FLOOR
AI-Proof %	45%	40% min
Strategic layer	55%	45% min
Framing dimension	15%	12% min
Deciding & Directing	15%	12% min
AI-Dominant (ceiling)	35%	40% max

If something isn't working

AI-DOMINANT NOT DROPPING BY MONTH 3

Recovered time is being absorbed by more output work. Every routed activity needs a named destination in the AI-Proof zone — write it down before routing.

DECISION LOG FEWER THAN 4 ENTRIES BY MONTH 3

Decisions are happening but not being recognised. Review the last 4 weeks, add retroactively. Set a recurring 5-minute Friday slot to update before the week closes.

TRAJECTORY NO LONGER EXPANDING

The most important warning signal. Check immediately: have Framing or Deciding dropped below 12%? If yes — execution pressure has crowded out AI-Proof work. Identify what consumed it and route or delegate within one week.

"Performance earns the next cycle.
Positioning shapes the next five."

ADD A 30-MIN STRATEGY SESSION

Nitin will interpret your results, challenge your assumptions, and define the 3 highest-leverage moves for your exact profile.

Scheduled within 7 days · ₹2,100 add-on · Total: ₹2,500 · nitin@axionindex.org

BOOK SESSION →

Nitin Nahata · Founder, Axionindex · CHRO, Gameskraft · nitin@axionindex.org · axionindex.org/ai-edge